

Santiago Zapata Mejía

QA Automation Lead · Automation Architect · Product Quality Engineering

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Pereira, Colombia · Remote Nearshore

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA Automation Lead who designs automated quality systems to cut production defects and speed releases. Specialty: Playwright + TypeScript, agent terminals (Herder), LLM consumption (Grok, Claude, OpenAI), and Jev (TypeSafe AI) for structured decisions (numeric/logical classifications software consumes directly · not chat). At DailyBot (YC W19) I run multi-platform E2E quality and ship product fixes; at LingoQuesto I was Responsable de Calidad with evidence-backed release gates. Open source, bilingual blog, and QAConf Eje Cafetero.

Impact ~800 automated tests (Playwright, Cypress, Selenium) · ~176 suites stood up · CI/CD with Jenkins, Docker, and GitHub Actions · API contracts (pytest) · ~311 defects caught in validation · ~650 product commits · evidence-backed release gates

CORE COMPETENCIES

Playwright · Cypress · Selenium · Robot Framework · TypeScript · JavaScript · Python · Multi-platform E2E (Slack, Teams, Discord, GChat, Web, CLI) · Agent terminals (Herder) · LLMs (Grok, Claude, OpenAI) · Jev / TypeSafe AI · MCP · API automation & contracts · Jenkins · GitHub Actions · Docker · Release gates · Sentry · k6 · Visual regression · multi-browser / iPad · Linear · EdTech / LTI · evidence-first automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Lead / Product Automation Lead · DailyBot Jan 2023 - Present

Y Combinator W19 · Remote · Technical owner of product quality (IC) · Multi-platform SaaS

- I have been responsible for end-to-end product quality for a YC-backed SaaS: I decide what can move from staging to production, maintain Playwright E2E tests, and validate across Slack, Teams, Discord, Google Chat, web, and CLI.
- Designed and operated a **multi-platform automated validation system**: ~160 audits and ~311 documented defects (~84 high/critical), with reproducible screenshots/steps and Linear escalation.
- Maintain **Playwright + TypeScript** automation (~120 suites; critical set of ~22 tests) on **Jenkins and Docker**; fixed CI breakages that blocked E2E (**11 audited recoveries**, several merged).
- Analyzed **86 support tickets** (Mar-Aug 2026): found the code-level root cause in **83/86** and fully reproduced **26** with E2E; documented **63 recurring bug patterns**.
- Delivered product fixes across frontend, API, and chatbot (~650 commits in 4 repositories; **50+ Linear issues** completed as owner).
- Core quality stack with Herder, LLMs (Grok/Claude/OpenAI) and Jev (TypeSafe: structured decisions, not chat) · less manual work.

QA Lead & Automation Architect (Responsable de Calidad) · LingoQuesto Mar 2025 - Oct 2026 · 1y 7m

EdTech · Independent contractor · Remote · 1 yr 7 mos · Official quality program and staging/production go/no-go

- Authored and adopted the official team **Quality Master Plan** (ready/done criteria, Linear roles, mandatory evidence, Pass/Fail/Blocked decisions) for frontend, backend, bot, and realtime AI.
- Was accountable for go/no-go on staging and production releases, with mandatory environment separation and consultative input on merge-to-release.
- Scaled Learning Platform Playwright from near zero to ~56 suites / ~273 tests (~120 critical Chromium set), multi-browser, iPad smoke, and API contract checks with **pytest**.
- Reached ~80% coverage of critical classroom flows in ~3 months, prioritizing risk (speaking/AI tutor, i18n, grading/export, admin, LTI).
- Left QA operations with reproducible proof: ~86 reports, ~2,650 screenshots, ~88 HTML deliverables for the tracker, and controls so failing work is not marked as OK.
- Owned production quality and Support-Product bridging: live validation, bug classification (~64 register), and Crisp/Trips tooling verified in the real app before customer replies.

Additional contributions · ZapataMejia

Open source · github.com/ZapataMejia · automation frameworks ready for real teams

qa-engineering-portfolio	Hub for UI, API, performance, and visual regression frameworks
Playwright Framework	POM · fixtures · Allure · Docker · GitHub Actions · ~32 tests
Playwright MCP Starter	Browser automation with Model Context Protocol
AI Testing / Generator	Self-healing · natural-language generation · CI
Visual · Cypress E2E	Multi-browser · BDD/Cucumber · POM · ~34 tests
API Testing · k6	pytest/Pydantic · smoke → soak · Grafana · ~28 tests
Robot Framework	Browser Library · Playwright · RequestsLibrary · Docker
Blog · Astro / Netlify	Bilingual ES/EN site · public proof of craft

PUBLICATIONS & SPEAKING

Technical Blog · QAConf Eje Cafetero

ES/EN articles on Playwright MCP, E2E, visual regression, and quality programs. **Talks and workshop support** at QAConf Eje Cafetero · zapatamejia.netlify.app

EDUCATION & STANDARDS

Software Engineering - CIAF · School of Engineering

In progress

Undergraduate · Currently completing the degree · Pereira, Colombia

Tecnólogo en Desarrollo de Software - CIAF · School of Engineering

Jul 17, 2026

Undergraduate · Software Engineering · Pereira · MEN · Acta 6518 · Book 25 · Folio 399 · Acreditta

APIs · Git · QA · data modeling · Agile · requirements · system design/maintenance · technical docs

Standards (CIAF plan)

ITIL® · COBIT® · ISO 9001 · ISO/IEC 12207 · 25000 · 9126 · 29119 · Law 603/2000 · Law 23/1982

Additional training

EPAM Campus - QA Manual & Automation · Cypress · Selenium + Python · CI/CD · Agile Testing · English A2

SKILLS

Languages	TypeScript · JavaScript · Python · SQL · HTML/CSS · Bash · Java
Automation	Playwright · Cypress · Selenium · Robot Framework · POM · fixtures · BDD/Cucumber · Herder · MCP · Allure
API & data	REST · GraphQL · pytest · Pydantic · JSON Schema · Vitest · Mocha
Perf. / Visual	k6 (smoke/load/stress/spike/soak) · Grafana · visual regression
CI/CD	Jenkins · GitHub Actions · Docker · Git · Amplify · staging/production
Platforms	Slack · Teams · Discord · Google Chat · Web · CLI · Automations · Forms · Check-ins · Stripe · LTI
Ops	Sentry · Herder · Grok/Claude/OpenAI · Jev · root-cause analysis · Crisp
Quality	Linear · Jira · ready/done criteria · RACI roles · release gates · ISO/IEC 29119 / 25000 / 9126
AI / Agents	Herder · Grok · Claude · OpenAI · Jev (TypeSafe) · MCP · structured decisions
Spoken	Spanish - Native · English - B1 (CEFR)